Stranded on a Mountain

The Team Building Survival Game

As well as being a fun exercise, this will also give team members the chance to see what type of role they naturally take with a group. This will help with deciding on roles. You could either do the activity with the whole group or split the groups into two smaller ones. Explain the exercise like this:

> After your small light aircraft crashes, your group, wearing casual clothing, is stranded on a forested mountain in appalling winter weather (snow covered, sub-freezing conditions), anywhere between 50 and 200 miles from civilization (you are not sure of your whereabouts, and radio contact was lost one hour before you crashed, so the search operation has no precise idea of your location either). The plane is about to burst into flames and you have a few moments to gather some items. Aside from the clothes you are wearing, which do not include coats, you have no other items. It is possible that you may be within mobile phone signal range, but unlikely. Your aim is to survive as a group until rescued.
>
> From the following list choose just 10 items that you would take from the plane, after which it and everything is destroyed by fire.
>
> First you have 5 minutes by yourself to consider and draw up your own individual list of what the team should have, without consulting with other members of the group. Keep this list after presenting it briefly to the group. Then you have 15 minutes as a group to discuss and agree on a list on behalf of the group. Nominate a spokesperson of the group and present the new list.

Afterwards, you can discuss with them as a whole the benefits of discussion, teamwork, collective expertise, group communication skills, etc., in the team approach to compiling the list, compared to each individual working alone to establish a list.

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LIST OF ITEMS:

- [ ] Pack of 6 boxes of 50 matches
- [ ] Roll of polythene sheeting 3m x 2m
- [ ] 1 bottle of Brandy
- [ ] 1 crate of bottled spring water
- [ ] Small tool box containing hammer, screwdriver set, adjustable wrench, hacksaw, large penknife
- [ ] Box of distress signal flares
- [ ] Small basic first aid kit containing plasters, bandages, antiseptic ointment, small pair of scissors, and pain-killer tablets
- [ ] Tri-band mobile phone with infrared port and half charged battery
- [ ] Clockwork transistor radio
- [ ] Gallon container full of fresh water
- [ ] Box of 36 – 50gm chocolate bars
- [ ] Shovel
- [ ] Short hand-held axe
- [ ] Handgun with magazine of 20 rounds
- [ ] 20m of 200kg nylon rope
- [ ] Box of 24 – 20gm bags of peanuts
- [ ] Box of tissues
- [ ] Laptop computer with infrared port, modem, unknown software and data, and unknown battery life
- [ ] Inflatable 4-person life raft
- [ ] Compass
- [ ] Large full aerosol can of insect killer spray
- [ ] Small half-full aerosol can of air freshener spray
- [ ] Notebook and pencil
- [ ] Traveling games kit including chess, backgammon & draughts
- [ ] Sewing Kit
- [ ] Whistle
- [ ] Flashlight with a set of spare batteries
- [ ] Box of 50-night light 6-hour candles
- [ ] Bag of 6 large blankets

Individual List

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

Group List

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

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